

# Christine CAI

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## RELEVANT WORK EXPERIENCE

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**Prosperity Now, Applied Research**, remote (based in Philadelphia, PA)

**Research Scientist**

Jul 2023 – Oct 2025

- Conducted data analysis and visualization for applied research projects; wrote reports and blog posts.
- Mentored and managed junior coworkers; streamlined data workflows & pipelines.
- Designed and implemented a novel methodology based on machine learning and small-area estimation methods to estimate local wealth disaggregated by race/ethnicity using SQL, Python, R and Stata.
- Translated complex methods and findings to non-technical audiences, including CEO & funders.

**Amazon, Alexa Economics & Measurement**, remote (based in Philadelphia, PA)

**Economist Intern**

Jun 2022 – Aug 2022

- Adjusted a Double Machine Learning model to test robustness and examine heterogeneous treatment effects using SQL & Python; implemented matched diff-in-diff methods to validate their production model.

**Princeton University, Department of Economics**, Princeton, NJ

**Teaching Assistant**

Sep 2020 – Jun 2022

- *Graduate Student Teaching Award* for ECO313 Econometric Applications (Spring 2021).
- Taught undergraduate econometrics and microeconomics; advised 18 junior theses (3 prize winners).

**Research Assistant** with Prof. Leah BOUSTAN

Jun 2019 – Aug 2019

**University of Chicago, Booth School of Business**, Chicago, IL

**Research Professional**

Jun 2016 – Jun 2018

- Wrote Stata code for the behind-the-scenes running of a randomized field experiment (RCT); cleaned and analyzed data; conducted literature reviews; supported presentations and paper (re)submissions.

## SELECTED RESEARCH

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- [White Flight from Asian Immigration: Evidence from California Public Schools](#) (with Leah BOUSTAN & Tammy TSENG), *Journal of Urban Economics: Insights* (2024).
- [Vertical Connections Matter: School Alumni Networks and Labor-Market Outcomes](#) (with Mahsa KHOSHNAMEA), *working paper*.
- [Tightening Immigration Policy: Unintended Consequences on Hispanic U.S. Citizens' Healthcare-Seeking Behavior and Health Status](#), *working paper*.

## EDUCATION

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**Princeton University**, Princeton, NJ

**Ph.D., Economics** (advisors: Prof. Leah BOUSTAN & Prof. Ilyana KUZEMKO)

2023

**M.A., Economics** (fields: Labor Economics & Public Finance)

2020

**University of Pennsylvania, Wharton School**, Philadelphia, PA

**Visiting Ph.D. Student in Economics**, IvyPlus Exchange Scholar Program

2022–2023

**Sciences Po**, Paris, France

**M.A., Economics & Public Policy**, *Summa Cum Laude* (ranked 1<sup>st</sup>)

2015

- Recipient of the *Best Master Thesis in Economics* award

**B.A., Social Sciences, concentration in Economics**, *Cum Laude* (top 10%) in 2011-2012

2013

## TECHNICAL SKILLS & LANGUAGES

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**Expertise areas:** Causal inference, applied microeconomics (labor, public, education, health).

**Programming/software:** Stata, Python, RStudio, SQL (Redshift, BigQuery), cloud environments (AWS, GCP),  
L<sup>A</sup>T<sub>E</sub>X, Microsoft Office, Git.

**Languages:** French (native), Chinese dialect of Wenzhou (native), English (fluent), Spanish (advanced),  
Mandarin Chinese (basics), Russian (beginner).